

12 PAST CONTINUOUS TENSE

We use the **past continuous** to say that something was happening in the past.

Form

👉 Subject + Helping Verbs (was/were) + Verb 1st - form + ing + Object

Affirmatives

Subject	Helping Verb	Verb+ing	Object
I/he/she/it/Ali	was	playing	cricket.
We/you/they	were	playing	cricket.

Negatives

Subject	Helping Verb+not	Verb+ing	Object
I/he/she/it/Ali	was not (wasn't)	playing	cricket.
We/you/they	were not (weren't)	playing	cricket.

Interrogatives			
Helping Verb	Subject	Verb+ing	Object+?
Was	I/he/she/it/Ali	playing	cricket?
Were	we/you/they	playing	cricket?

12.1

Complete the sentences with the **past continuous** form of the verbs in brackets.

- 👉 She was writing (write) an email.
- 👉 You _____ (sleep).
- 👉 We _____ (have) some problems with the computer this morning.
- 👉 I _____ (dream) about a flying fish.
- 👉 It _____ (snow) last night.
- 👉 They _____ (not / help) us.
- 👉 The phone _____ (not / ring) yesterday.
- 👉 You _____ (not / listen) to me.
- 👉 She _____ (watch) a film at seven o'clock.
- 👉 _____ it _____ (rain) at six o'clock?
- 👉 _____ you _____ (wear) jeans yesterday?

12.2

Work in pairs. Ask and answer the questions.

 What were you doing yesterday morning?

I was studying at school.

 Where were you going in the afternoon?

 Who was helping you with your homework last week?

 Who was talking to the teacher during class yesterday?

 Who was sharing the lunch with you at recess yesterday?

 Who was playing football with you after school last Friday?

Note

We can also use **Past continuous** with **past simple**. Past continuous is used as a background or longer action while past simple is used as a shorter action which interrupted the past continuous.

For example:

-  When I was sleeping, Sofia woke me up.
-  Sofia woke me up when I was sleeping.
-  When he was running, he stumbled over a stone.
-  He stumbled over a stone when he was running.
-  When you were going to office, you came across your friend.
-  You came across your friend when you were going to your office.
-  When we were studying, the power went off.
-  The power went off when we were studying.
-  When my mum was cooking, the doorbell rang.
-  The doorbell rang when my mum was cooking.

We can use two verbs in the **past continuous** with **and** to talk about two past actions in progress at the same time.

I was doing my homework and my grandma was making soup.

12.3

Circle the correct answer.

👉 When I **looked** / **was looking** out of the window, it **snowed** / **was snowing**.

👉 We **worked** / **were working** in the garden when we **found** / **were finding** some old money.

👉 When I **made** / **was making** the cake, I **dropped** / **was dropping** the bowl.

👉 I **cleaned** / **was cleaning** the kitchen when she **arrived** / **was arriving**.

👉 When I **started** / **was starting** school, we **lived** / **were living** in the old house.

👉 I **saw** / **was seeing** you when I **waited** / **was waiting** for the bus.